

```
= '%u';
user_query = SELECT * FROM active_users_userdb WHERE user =
'%u';
iterate_query = SELECT user FROM active_users_userdb;
```

default_pass_scheme: This is the default password hashing method to be used. SHA512-CRYPT is the highest possible algorithm supported by Dovecot on most Linux distributions at the time of writing this. It supports BLF-CRYPT as well, which uses the highly secure BCRYPT algorithm, but that requires a patched *glibc* installation.

password_query – The SQL query that Dovecot must use to authenticate a user.

user_query – The SQL query for fetching user information.

iterate_query – The SQL query for pre-fetching users. This is used by Dovecot when we run the mail indexer.

Authentication configuration: This is done in *conf.d/10-auth.conf*.

```
disable_plaintext_auth = yes
auth_mechanisms = plain login
!include auth-sql.conf
```

PLAIN and LOGIN are the most commonly used authentication mechanisms. With the first option, *plaintext* authentication over *cleartext* (non-encrypted connection) is disabled. You can enable it if needed.

In *auth-sql.conf*, we just need the following:

```
passdb {
    driver = sql
    args = /etc/dovecot/dovecot-sql.conf.ext
}

userdb {
    driver = prefetch
}

userdb {
    driver = sql
    args = /etc/dovecot/dovecot-sql.conf.ext
}
```

In *10-mail.conf* there are various settings to be configured, but the most important ones are:

```
mail_location = mbox:/var/vmail/%d/%n
mail_privileged_group = vmail
mail_fsycn = optimized
mail_plugins = expire fts fts_lucene quota trash virtual
```

mail_location sets the path on the filesystem to store emails. *Mdbox* is a format created by Dovecot itself to overcome performance related and other issues with old

storage formats like *mbox* and *maildir*.

mail_plugins enables various plugins for all the protocols.

Logging can be configured in *10-logging.conf*. Configure it according to your needs. But temporarily, while the server isn't ready for production yet, enable the following options:

```
log_path = syslog
auth_debug = yes
auth_verbose = yes
mail_debug = yes
```

This will help in debugging any issues with Dovecot. If you don't have syslog, you can set it to a filename.

In *10-master.conf*, ports and protocol mapping are configured:

```
service imap-login {
    inet_listener imap {
        port = 143
        ssl = no
    }
    inet_listener imaps {
        port = 993
        ssl = yes
    }
}

service_count = 0

vsz_limit = 256M
}

service lmtp {
    unix_listener /var/spool/postfix/private/dovecot-lmtp {
        group = postfix
        user = postfix
        mode = 0600
    }
}

service auth {
    unix_listener auth-userdb {
        mode = 0600
        user = vmail
        group = vmail
    }

    unix_listener /var/spool/postfix/private/auth {
        mode = 0660
        user = postfix
        group = postfix
    }

    user = dovecot
}
```